

Kafue Town Council Open Governance and Development Dataset

Data Description Paper - CSC 4792 Data Mining and Warehousing | Group 40 | September 2026

Abstract

This paper describes a curated, source-traceable dataset assembled from the official Kafue Town Council website. The dataset records district profile facts, council functions, official news, and metadata for linked public resources covering Constituency Development Fund (CDF) activities, integrated development planning, budgets, financial statements, projects, performance reports, and council minutes. The release is intended for data-mining and exploratory analysis of local-government service delivery and public-finance information in Zambia. Records preserve the source page, source type, and retrieval date so that future users can extend the dataset by parsing the linked documents.

Keywords: Kafue Town Council; Zambia; local government; CDF; public finance; governance; data mining

1. Specifications Table

Item	Description
Subject area	Data mining and warehousing; local-government open information
Geographic scope	Kafue District, Lusaka Province, Zambia
Data source	Official Kafue Town Council website and its public linked resources
Collection date	11 September 2026
Release size	27 records; 11 columns; pipe-delimited CSV
Dataset URL	https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/kamfwamwansa/kafue-town-council-open-governance-and-development
Reuse value	Local-government profiling, CDF project analysis, source discovery, governance research, and teaching data integration

2. Value of the Data

Kafue Town Council publishes information across ordinary web pages and linked office documents. These materials are useful but fragmented: district facts, departmental mandates, CDF records, budgets, financial statements, project lists, performance reports, and minutes are not presented as one analysis-ready dataset. This release provides a common record structure with stable identifiers, a category field, source URLs, and retrieval dates. It therefore creates a starting point for questions such as: which service areas are represented in CDF projects; how do council functions map to development activities; and which official documents are available for longitudinal analysis?

3. Data Description

The main file is named `db-unza26-csc4792-kafue_council_information.csv` and uses the pipe character (`|`) as the separator. It contains the following record classes:

- fact: curated district, mandate, department, and official-news facts;
- resource: metadata for public files linked by the council;
- news: official news items and their summaries.

The dataset has 15 fact records, 9 linked-resource records, and 3 news records. Example quantitative values include an approximate district area of 4,471 km², one constituency, 18 wards, a reported population of 219,574 people, nine motorbikes handed over under COSP, and a reported 600-hectare irrigation target. Quantitative fields are accompanied by units where applicable.

4. Methodology

The collection process began by identifying Group 40's assigned council in the project specification: Kafue Town Council. The official website was then reviewed through its district, Quick Facts, department, mandate, CDF, publications, and news sections. Publicly linked files were inventoried by title, file type, URL, and originating page. A small curated fact layer was added for assignment-relevant items that were clearly stated on the pages. Source wording was retained in descriptions and no missing values were guessed.

The reproducible codebase includes `scrape_kafue.py`, which uses the Python standard library to fetch HTML, extract page text and links, identify linked office documents, and write a pipe-delimited CSV. The accompanying Jupyter Notebook documents loading, schema checks, cleaning, quality checks, and export.

5. Data Processing and Quality

Cleaning consists of whitespace normalisation, stable record identifiers, explicit record types, preservation of source URLs, and separation of values from units. Duplicate navigation links and empty anchor labels are excluded from the linked-resource inventory. Validation checks confirm the required filename pattern, pipe delimiter, presence of core fields, and source traceability. The current release does not infer financial amounts from narrative text and does not silently transform ambiguous figures.

6. Limitations and Future Enrichment

The current release captures the official resource inventory but does not yet parse every linked PDF, spreadsheet, and document into row-level financial and project tables. The next release should download and extract the 2022-2024 CDF submissions, expenditure returns, approved project lists, budgets, financial statements, performance reports, procurement plans, and minutes. It should add fields for financial year, ward, project status, sector, approved amount, actual amount, currency, and document page or sheet reference. Future releases should also retain raw extracts alongside cleaned tables for auditability.

7. Ethics, Licensing, and Reuse

The dataset uses publicly accessible council information for an academic assignment. Users should cite the originating council pages and linked documents, verify figures against the latest source versions, and avoid treating the collection date as a guarantee that the council website remains unchanged. The Kaggle release is accompanied by source URLs and a README describing scope and limitations.

8. References

Kafue Town Council. Official website. <https://www.kafuecouncil.gov.zm/>

CSC 4792 project specification. Mini Project Practical Assignment: Data Mining and Warehousing, 2025/26.

Kafue Town Council Open Governance and Development Dataset. Kaggle.

<https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/kamfwamwansa/kafue-town-council-open-governance-and-development>